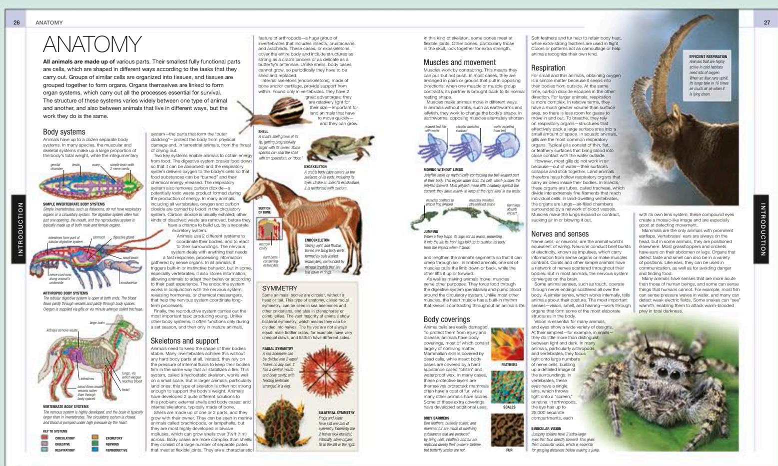
ABOUT THIS BOOK

Animal is organized into 3 main sections: a general **Introduction** to animals and their lives; a section on the world's main **Habitats**; and the main part of the book, **The Animal Kingdom**, which is dedicated to the description of animal groups and species. At the end of the book, a detailed glossary defines all zoological and technical terms used, while a full index lists all the groups and species featured, by both Latin name and common name, including alternative common names.

INTRODUCTION

Animal begins with an overview of all aspects of animal life. This includes an account of what an animal is—and how it differs from other living things. It also examines animal anatomy, life cycles, evolution, behavior, and conservation. In addition, there is a comprehensive presentation of the classification scheme that underpins the species profiles in **The Animal Kingdom**.



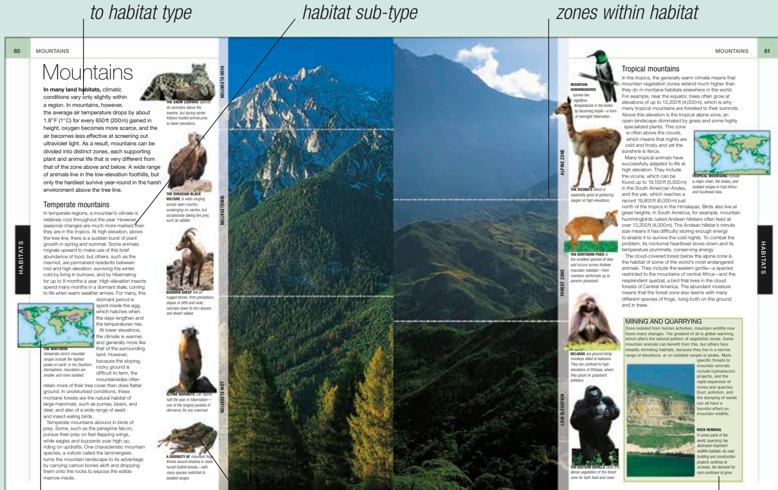
HABITATS

This section looks at the world's main animal habitats. Coverage of each habitat is divided into 2 parts. The first (illustrated below) describes the habitat itself, including its climate and plant life, and the types of animals found there. The pages that immediately follow describe how the anatomy and behavior of animals are adapted to suit the conditions in which they live.

general introduction to habitat type

description of more specific habitat sub-type

dotted lines identify distinct zones within habitat



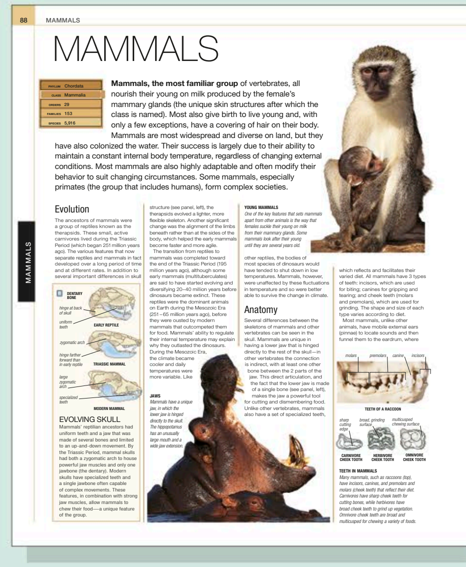
map showing global distribution of habitat

photographs show representative animals found within each zone

feature on conservation issues

THE ANIMAL KINGDOM

This section of *Animal* is divided into 6 chapters: mammals, birds, reptiles, amphibians, fishes, and invertebrates. Each chapter begins with an introduction to the animal group. Lower-ranked groups such as orders and families are then introduced, followed by profiles of the species classified within them. The invertebrates are organized slightly differently (see opposite), while passerine birds are profiled at family level, with only representative species shown.



HABITAT SYMBOLS

Symbols in profiles are listed as shown below, not in order of main occurrence.

- Temperate forest, including woodland
- Coniferous forest, including woodland
- Tropical forest and rain forest
- Mountains, highlands, scree slopes
- Desert and semidesert
- Open habitats, including grassland, moor, heath, savanna, fields, scrub
- Wetlands and all still bodies of water, including lakes, ponds, pools, marshes, bogs, and swamps
- Rivers, streams, and all flowing water
- Mangrove swamps, above or below the waterline
- Coastal areas, including beaches and cliffs, areas just above high tide, in the intertidal zone, and in shallow, offshore waters
- Seas and oceans
- Coral reefs and waters immediately around them
- Polar regions, including tundra and icebergs
- Urban areas, including buildings, parks, and gardens
- Parasitic; living on or inside another animal

DATA FIELD

Summary information is given at the start of each profile. Measurements are for adult males of the species and may be a typical range, single-figure average, or maximum, depending on available records.

LENGTH (all groups, except Invertebrates)
MAMMALS: head and body. **BIRDS:** tip of bill to tip of tail. **REPTILES:** length of carapace for tortoises and turtles; head and body, including tail, for all other species. **FISHES & AMPHIBIANS:** head and body, including tail.

TAIL (Mammals only) Length.

WEIGHT (Mammals, Birds, and Fishes only)
Body weight.

SOCIAL UNIT (Mammals only)
Whether a species lives mainly alone (*Individual*), in a *Group*, in a *Pair*, or varies between these units (*Variable*).

PLUMAGE (Birds only)
Whether sexes are *alike* or *different*.

MIGRATION (Birds only)
Whether a bird is a *Migrant*, *Partial migrant*, *Nonmigrant*, or *Nomadic*.

BREEDING (Reptiles and Fishes only)
Whether the species is *Viviparous*, *Oviparous*, or *Ovoviviparous*.

HABIT (Reptiles and Amphibians only)
Whether the species is partly or wholly *Terrestrial*, *Aquatic*, *Burrowing*, or *Arboreal*.

BREEDING SEASON (Amphibians only)
The time of year in which breeding occurs.

SEX (Fishes only)
Whether the species has separate males and females (*Male/Female*), is a *Hermaphrodite*, or a *Sequential hermaphrodite*.

OCCURRENCE (Invertebrates only)
Number of species in the family, class, or phylum; their distribution and the microhabitats they can be found in.

STATUS (all groups)
Animal uses The IUCN Red List (see p.33) and other threat categories, as follows:

EXTINCT IN THE WILD (IUCN) Known only to survive in captivity, as a naturalized population outside its natural range, or as a small, managed population that has been reintroduced.

CRITICALLY ENDANGERED (IUCN) Facing an extremely high risk of extinction in the wild in the immediate future.

ENDANGERED (IUCN) Facing a very high risk of extinction in the wild in the near future.

VULNERABLE (IUCN) Facing a high risk of extinction in the wild in the medium-term future.

NEAR THREATENED (IUCN) Strong possibility of becoming endangered in the near future.

LEAST CONCERN (IUCN) Low-risk category that includes widespread and common species.

DATA DEFICIENT (IUCN) Not a threat category. Population and distribution data is insufficient for assessment.

NOT EVALUATED Data not yet assessed against the 5 IUCN criteria.

For fuller details see The IUCN Red List website (www.iucnredlist.org)